

The River Answers Back: Pressure Builds

河流的回应：压力上升

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The pressure built at the **low** point of the season, when the **entire group** had two hours a week and a **simple** question: **can** we keep the record going for another period? “Either we pay the five families or we draw the whole thing down,” the director said. The difference would show up at the foot of the bank, where the water gets its first range.

The **wind** came off the **lake** and the **storm** took the **wing** off the shed. A **dry pool** of **acid**, a **shower** of **hail**, and a **pipe** with a broken **collar**: the **restoration** cost more than the sensors, and the **bacteria** in the wetland did not care about the budget.

The group tried to **hide** the problem in a **disguise** of **honesty**. “A **straw**, a **balloon**, and a **stool** are not a laboratory,” the boatman said. “The **oxygen** in that water is the only record that matters.” A **cereal** of local grain, a **drip** of oil, and a **tick** of the clock kept the camp running.

The **twin** pressures were money and time. A **barbecue** for the volunteers, a **paste** of **soap** and ash, and a **crocodile** warning on the bank: the project was long, and probably too long for the hour it had.

The **ozone** and the **climate** range had both been added to the programme, and neither of them could be measured from a single **pole**. “We get the **tongue** of the river and the **tongue** of the ministry in the same room,” Maya wrote, “and we call that **parliamentary** language.”

The next step was the **bait** and the **splash**: a small mark on the water, a photograph, and a list of the twelve things the group would no longer pretend to know. The period ended with the promise of an anniversary review, and with the **concrete** pier still unfinished. A **flower** on the bank, a **neck** of land, a **blind** corner and a **cough** in the night: the development of the district was written in small things, not in the **storm**. The **entire group** could see it and could not fix it in one period.

中文翻译

压力在这一季的低点累积起来，当时整个小组每周只有两个小时，以及一个简单的问题：我们还能把这个记录再维持一个周期吗？“要么我们付钱给那五个家庭，要么我们把整件事拉倒，”主管说。“差别”会在岸脚显现出来，那里是水面获得它第一段范围的地方。

风从湖上吹来，风暴掀掉了棚子的一个翼。一池干涸的酸、一阵冰雹，以及一根领口破裂的管子：修复的费用超过了传感器，而湿地里的细菌并不在乎预算。

小组试图以诚实为伪装把问题藏起来。“一根麦管、一只气球和一张凳子不是实验室，”船夫说，“那水里的氧才是唯一要紧的记录。”一份本地的谷物早餐、一滴油，以及时钟的一下滴答，让营地维持运转。

两股压力是钱和时间。为志愿者办的一场烤肉、一坨肥皂加灰的糊，以及岸边一条鳄鱼警告：这个项目很长，而且对这仅有的一小时来说大概太长。

臭氧和气候范围都被加进了方案，而这两者都无法从一根杆子上测出来。“我们把河流的舌头和部里的舌头放进同一个房间，”曼雅写道，“然后把它叫做议会语言。”

下一步是饵与飞溅：水面上的一个小记号、一张照片，以及一份清单，列出小组不再假装知道的那十二件事。这个周期以一场周年复审的承诺结束，而那座混凝土码头仍未完工。岸边的一朵花、一段地峡、一个死角，以及夜里的一声咳嗽：这个片区的发展写在小事里，而不是写在风暴里。整个小组都看得见它，却无法在一个周期内修好它。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
can kæn POS: vt	vt. 装罐; n. 罐头, 容器; aux. 能, 可以; [计] 作废字符 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. airtight sealed metal container for food or drink or paint etc.; n. the quantity contained in a can; n. a bu...
low ləu POS: n	n. 低点, 低价, 低, 牛叫声; a. 低的, 消沉的, 低等的, 浅的, 卑贱的; adv. 低下地, 谦卑地, 低; vi. 牛叫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an air mass of lower pressure; often brings precipitation; n. British political cartoonist (born in New Zea...
simple 'simpl POS: a	a. 简单的, 普通的, 朴素的, 单纯的, 绝对的, 初级的, 原始的, 迟钝的; n. 出身低微者, 傻子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any herbaceous plant having medicinal properties; a. having few parts; not complex or complicated or involv...
entire in'taɪə POS: n	n. 整个, 全部; a. 全体的, 完全的, 全部的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. constituting the full quantity or extent; complete; s. (of leaves or petals) having a smooth edge; not brok...
wind wind POS: n	n. 风, 气息, 气味, 呼吸, 风声, 趋势, 空谈, 卷绕, 弯曲; vt. 使通风, 嗅出, 使喘气, 吹号角, 上发条, 缠绕, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. air moving (sometimes with considerable force) from an area of high pressure to an area of low pressure; n. ...
hide haɪd POS: n	n. 兽皮, 迹象, 躲藏处; vt. 藏, 隐瞒, 逃避, 剥...的皮, 隐藏; vi. 躲藏; [计] 隐藏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the dressed skin of an animal (especially a large animal); n. body covering of a living animal; v. prevent f...
flower 'flaʊə POS: n	n. 花, 开花植物, 精华, 盛时; vi. 开花, 发育, 旺盛, 成熟; vt. 用花装饰, 使开花 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a plant cultivated for its blooms or blossoms; n. reproductive organ of angiosperm plants especially one ha...
neck nek POS: n	n. 脖子, 衣领, 颈; vi. 拥抱, 拥吻, 收缩; vt. 割颈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of an organism (human or animal) that connects the head to the rest of the body; n. a narrow elong...
dry draɪ POS: a	a. 干的, 无酒的, 枯燥无味的, 干燥的; vt. 把...弄干; vi. 变干; n. 干, 干涸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a reformer who opposes the use of intoxicating beverages; v. remove the moisture from and make dry; v. becom...
pool pu:l POS: n	n. 池, 水塘, 石油层, 联营; vt. 合伙经营, 共享, 采掘, 汇聚成; vi. 汇合成塘, 淤积, 联营 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an excavation that is (usually) filled with water; n. an organization of people or resources that can be sh...
acid 'æsɪd POS: n	n. 酸, 酸类物质, 尖刻, 迷幻药; a. 酸的, 酸性的, 尖刻的, 敏锐的; [计] 自动文档参与索引生成程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various water-soluble compounds having a sour taste and capable of turning litmus red and reacting...
storm sto:m POS: n	n. 暴风雨, 骚动, 风波, 风暴, 猛攻; vi. 起风, 猛冲, 怒吼; vt. 猛攻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a violent weather condition with winds 64-72 knots (11 on the Beaufort scale) and precipitation and thunde...
wing wɪŋ POS: n	n. 翅膀, 翼, 机翼, 派别; vt. 给...装上翼, 飞过, 使飞, 空运, 增加...速度; vi. 飞行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a movable organ for flying (one of a pair); n. one of the horizontal airfoils on either side of the fuselag...
lake leɪk POS: n	n. 湖, 池, 色淀; v. (使)血球溶解 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a body of (usually fresh) water surrounded by land; n. a purplish red pigment prepared from lac or cochinea...
climate 'klaɪmɪt POS: n	n. 气候, 社会趋势, 气候区; [医] 气候 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the weather in some location averaged over some long period of time; n. the prevailing psychological state
parliamentary ,pa:lə'mentəri POS: a	a. 国会的, 议会的, 议会制度的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or having the nature of a parliament; s. having the supreme legislative power resting with a bo...
twin twin POS: n	n. 双胞胎中一人, 一对非常相像的人(或物)中的一个; a. 双胞胎的, 成对的, 孪生的; vi. 生双胞胎, 成对; vt. 怀(双胞胎) ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. either of two offspring born at the same time from the same pregnancy; n. a waterfall in the Snake River in...
pipe paɪp POS: n	n. 管, 导管, 输送管, 管状器官, 声带, 尖细的声音, 烟斗, 笛, 管乐器; vt. 以管输送, 吹哨子, 吹奏, 尖声唱; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tube with a small bowl at one end; used for smoking tobacco; n. a long tube made of metal or plastic that...
blind blaɪnd POS: n	n. 蒙蔽物, 窗帘; a. 盲目的, 瞎的, 不加思考的; vt. 使失明, 蒙蔽, 遮暗; adv. 盲目地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people who have severe visual impairments, considered as a group; n. a hiding place sometimes used by hunte...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
pole pəʊl POS: n	n. 波兰人, 极点, 磁极, 电极, 杆, 竿, 相反的极端; vt. 用竿支撑; vi. 撑篙 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a long (usually round) rod of wood or metal or plastic; n. a native or inhabitant of Poland; n. one of two d...
tongue tʌŋ POS: n	n. 舌, 语言能力, 讲话方式, 语言; vt. 舔, 斥责, 发...的音; vi. 使用舌头, 吹管乐器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mobile mass of muscular tissue covered with mucous membrane and located in the oral cavity; n. any long t...
shower ˈʃaʊə POS: n	n. 阵雨, 淋浴, 一阵, 展出者, 显示者; vi. 淋浴, 下雨雨; vt. 淋湿, 倾注 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a plumbing fixture that sprays water over you; n. washing yourself by standing upright under water sprayed...
concrete ˈkɒnkri:t POS: n	n. 凝结物, 混凝土; a. 具体的, 实在的, 混凝土的; v. (使)凝结, 用混凝土浇筑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong hard building material composed of sand and gravel and cement and water; v. cover with cement; v. f...
restoration ˌrestə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 恢复, 归还, 复位; [医] 恢复, 康复, 复位, 回复, 修复 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the reign of Charles II in England; 1660-1685; n. the act of restoring something or someone to a satisfacto...
bacteria bæk'tɪəriə POS: review required	pl. 细菌; [医] 细菌, [无芽胞]杆菌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (microbiology) single-celled or noncellular spherical or spiral or rod-shaped organisms lacking chlorophyl...
oxygen ˈɒksədʒən POS: n	n. 氧; [化] 氧O-2 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a nonmetallic bivalent element that is normally a colorless odorless tasteless nonflammable diatomic gas;...
collar ˈkɒlə POS: n	n. 衣领, 颈圈; vt. 控制, 扭住衣领, 给...装上领子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a band that fits around the neck and is usually folded over; n. (zoology) an encircling band or marking aro...
soap seʊp POS: n	n. 肥皂, 阿谀; vt. 以肥皂洗, 阿谀; [计] 评语 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cleansing agent made from the salts of vegetable or animal fats; n. money offered as a bribe; n. street na...
straw strɔː POS: n	n. 稻草, 麦管, 吸管, 一文不值的东西, 草帽; a. 稻草的, 稻草色的, 琐碎的, 无价值的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. plant fiber used e.g. for making baskets and hats or as fodder; n. a thin paper or plastic tube used to suc...
balloon bə'luːn POS: n	n. 气球; vt. 使成气球状; vi. 膨胀如气球, 激增 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. large tough nonrigid bag filled with gas or heated air; n. small thin inflatable rubber bag with narrow nec...
ozone ˈəʊzəʊn POS: n	n. 新鲜的空气, 臭氧, 使人愉快的影响; [化] 臭氧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a colorless gas (O3) soluble in alkalis and cold water; a strong oxidizing agent; can be produced by elect...
stool stuːl POS: n	n. 凳子, 大便, 粪便, 厕所; vi. 长新枝; vt. 引诱, 诱捕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a simple seat without a back or arms; n. (forestry) the stump of a tree that has been felled or headed for...
disguise dis'gaɪz POS: n	n. 假面目, 假装; vt. 假装, 隐瞒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an outward semblance that misrepresents the true nature of something; n. any attire that modifies the appea...
cough kɒf POS: n	n. 咳嗽; vi. 咳嗽; vt. 咳出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden noisy expulsion of air from the lungs that clears the air passages; a common symptom of upper res...
tick tɪk POS: n	n. 滴答声, 一瞬间, 壁虱, 褥套, 信用, 赊欠; vi. 滴答响, 活动; vt. 滴答地记录, 标记号于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a metallic tapping sound; n. any of two families of small parasitic arachnids with barbed proboscis; feed o...
cereal ˈsiəriəl POS: n	n. 谷类食品, 谷类植物; a. 谷类的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. grass whose starchy grains are used as food: wheat; rice; rye; oats; maize; buckwheat; millet; n. a breakfa...
drip driːp POS: n	n. 水滴; v. (使)滴下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. flowing in drops; the formation and falling of drops of liquid; n. the sound of a liquid falling drop by dr...
hail heɪl POS: n	n. 冰雹, 致敬, 欢呼, 招呼; vt. 向...欢呼, 致敬, 招呼, 使象下雹样落下; vi. 招呼, 下雹; interj. 万岁,... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. precipitation of ice pellets when there are strong rising air currents; n. many objects thrown forcefully t...
honesty ˈɒnɪsti POS: n	n. 诚实, 公正, 正直 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being honest; n. southeastern European plant cultivated for its fragrant purplish flowers an...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
bait beit POS: n	n. 饵; vt. 以饵引诱, 欺负; vi. 中途休息 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. anything that serves as an enticement; n. something used to lure fish or other animals into danger so they...
splash splæʃ POS: n	n. 飞溅, 污点, 一点儿, 溅泼声, 色斑; vi. 溅湿, 溅开, 飞溅; vt. 溅, 泼, 使溅起水, 洒, 使成斑驳状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sound like water splashing; n. a patch of bright color; n. the act of scattering water about haphazardly...
barbecue 'bɑ:bikju: POS: n	n. 烤肉; vt. 烤肉, 烧烤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. meat that has been barbecued or grilled in a highly seasoned sauce; n. a cookout in which food is cooked ov...
paste peist POS: n	n. 面团, 面食, 浆糊, 糊状物, 粘贴, 用拳重击; vt. 用浆糊粘, 张贴, 狠狠地打; [计] 粘贴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any mixture of a soft and malleable consistency; n. a hard, brilliant lead glass that is used in making art...
crocodile 'krɒkədail POS: n	n. 鳄鱼 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. large voracious aquatic reptile having a long snout with massive jaws and sharp teeth and a body covered w...